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Push launched to impeach Hegseth

GOP Rep. Massie submits resolution on Pentagon chief

By Konstantin Toropin and Steven Sloan
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Rep. Thomas Massie on Monday moved to force a vote to impeach Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, setting the stage for a dramatic vote on whether to remove one of the Trump administration's most prominent figures following sweeping election losses.

The impeachment resolution was introduced by Massie, a Kentucky Republican, as soon as the House opened for the first day of sessions after the midterms. It largely focuses on the war in Iran but also includes references to Hegseth's role in carrying out military actions in Yemen and Venezuela.

Massie said the secretary's actions amount to "high crimes and misdemeanors" and his leadership at the Pentagon "thus warrants impeachment."

President Donald Trump lashed out at Massie personally just hours after the congressman read the resolution, calling him a "loser" who "has a lot of hatred in his heart."

A vote in the House could come by midweek, putting pressure on Republicans — many of whom blamed their election wipeout on the Iran war — but next steps are highly uncertain.

House Speaker Mike Johnson had tried to prevent this outcome and warned lawmakers against impeaching the defense secretary while the U.S. is engaged in military actions in the Middle East.

"Impeaching a Cabinet secretary right now, especially the Department of War in the middle of hostilities abroad would be a terrible, terrible look, a terrible thing for our allies and our enemies to see that," Johnson, a Republican, said as he opened the chamber.

"We don't impeach Cabinet secretaries for political gain or for cheap tricks, and I think that's what this is and I think everybody knows it."

Most House Democrats are expected to support impeaching Hegseth, with Democratic Leader Hakeem Jeffries saying over the weekend it's time for the defense secretary to go.

If the House votes to impeach Hegseth, it would next go to the Senate for a potential trial. Republicans remain in the majority in both chambers, until the new Congress

See **HEGSETH** on Page A9

ELECTION 2027
CHICAGO MAYOR

Candidate gets flak for support of alderman

Giannoulias criticized over photo at event with Ald. Gardiner

By Alice Yin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayoral candidate Alexi Giannoulias faced heat this weekend from a Democratic committeeman over his support for a controversial Northwest Side alderman, an early sign of the difficulty he will have trying to appeal to more conservative Chicago voters without angering progressives.

On Thursday evening, Giannoulias posted a photo with Ald. Jim Gardiner, who was kicking off his campaign for a third term representing a ward stretching northwest from Irving Park to Sauganash.

"Great to be in Chicago's 45th Ward showing support for Alderman Jim Gardiner!" Giannoulias wrote on social media. "I am glad to support him as a community leader and to connect with so many neighbors who care deeply about the future of the 45th ward and our entire city."

The appearance triggered a mini-maelstrom online from both supporters and foes of the two-term alderman, including a statement from 45th Ward Democratic Committeeman Michael Rabbitt a few days later claiming that Giannoulias had called him with a mea culpa.

"Today, Alexi called me to acknowledge that his decision to attend the event was a mistake, and he apologized," Rabbitt wrote. "I expressed my deep disappointment with his public support of Gardiner, and indicated that our core values of integrity and accountability demand that we call this out publicly. I appreciate Alexi taking responsibility for his actions, but he must also publicly rescind his support for Gardiner."

One of the "Broadview Six" defendants who protested the Trump administration's immi-

See **CRITICISM** on Page A5



Andrea Biser, chief growth officer at Playdate, pours samples of Playdate nonalcoholic THC-infused rose wine for Leah McGill, center, and Sasha Beran-Hughes at Foxtrot Cafe in Chicago's Gold Coast neighborhood on Oct. 14. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Intoxicating hemp ban likely to shut many shops

Illinois prohibition will end unregulated legal market, but some businesses brace for fallout

By Robert McCoppin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The Wild West era of cannabis in Illinois may be coming to an end.

The sale of intoxicating hemp products, which have been legal but largely unregulated for the past eight years, is due to be banned in Illinois as of Thursday.

The prohibition on hemp THC — the stuff that gets users high — could put stores that sell the products out of business, industry members said. Those who work there are at risk of losing their jobs, and customers won't be able to buy their products, they said.

It also means an end to a legal loophole that has allowed the sale of intoxicating drugs to minors, untested and mislabeled products, and products that far exceeded state limits on THC.

But adults 21 and over may still buy state-legalized cannabis at licensed dispensaries, both standardizing and sanitizing an industry once known for its counter-cultural vibe.

So in the war between unlicensed small hemp businesses that popped up across the nation, and large multi-state organizations (MSOs) that dominate the industry, the big guys won. Last week, hemp businesses filed suit seeking a court order to stop the state ban, and were waiting for a ruling.

"I think most people on both sides agree that regulated markets would be a good thing for assuring quality assurance," said Donald Opitz, director of cannabis studies at DePaul University. "The concern is about how this is interrupting one of the last spaces where some inclusivity in the market remained. A lot of business owners who entered this space are from minority communities that have been pushed out of the legal cannabis market."

That concern was one of the reasons cited by Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson in vetoing a city-wide ban on hemp businesses early this year. The mayor wanted to regulate and tax hemp.

Similarly, a battle raged among lawmakers at the state and federal levels who wanted to regulate and tax the product, and those who wanted to ban it.

Both sides of the industry lobbied for their side, and a Politico investigation showed that the alcohol industry got involved in lobbying prosecutors, including

See **HEMP** on Page A2

Brand gets 10.5 years for rape, assault

Russell Brand was sentenced in a British court Monday to 10 ½ years in prison for raping one woman and sexually assaulting three others years ago during his rise to stardom. **Nation & World**

Bears reflect on ugly victory over Bucs

After beating last year's Super Bowl participants, coach Ben Johnson can classify Sunday's 27-24 win over the Buccaneers as a gritty win — one that's difficult to come by in the NFL. **Sports**

Area colleges, universities aim to embrace AI

Schools grappling with how to manage, integrate the new tech

By Kate Perez
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

At DePaul University, roughly a dozen students routinely wrestle with how much artificial intelligence should and could influence the human experience. They spend hours at the Responsible AI Systems and Experiences, or RAISE, Lab on the university's Loop campus, exploring how AI affects daily life.

Like many higher education institutions, DePaul has grappled with AI integration on campus in recent years. The school is faced with how to manage, embrace and integrate AI use while weighing the opinions of campus stakeholders, from faculty, administrators and students.

To help the university community get a handle on AI, DePaul recently released "Guiding Principles on Artificial Intelligence," a tome calling for academic integrity, intellectual honesty, transparency and human-centered use of the technology.

The principles were born out of the school's 26-member Provost's Advisory Committee on Artificial Intelligence, which worked for over a year to develop them. It meets monthly to discuss policy, practices and how AI is used in the classroom.

DePaul's AI principles,

See **AI** on Page A5



DePaul University students Aarchi Koshiya, left, and Sameed Iqbal work in the Responsible AI Systems and Experiences lab during class on Oct. 22. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

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WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY	WED.	THU.
H:63 L:39	H:58 L:42	H:45 L:34

Complete details on Page A12

INDEX

Almanac A9
Arts & Living B7
Business B1
Comics B10-11
Crossword B11
Editorials A6
Horoscope B10
Nation & World B4
Television B9

179th year No. 314
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